

### Phenomenological Compression

The framework attempts phenomenological compression:  
transforming diffuse internal suffering into interpretable recursive structures.

Rather than treating depressive states exclusively as diagnostic categories,  
the model attempts to formalize how unresolved affective experience may persist, recur, and  
shape cognition over time.

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### Background Signal Hypothesis

Persistent unresolved affective states may operate similarly to a continuously active low-salience  
background process.

This background signal may be:

- difficult to consciously isolate
- continuously present
- indirectly influential on cognition and behavior
- not always linguistically accessible

The individual may not consciously identify the signal itself,  
but may instead experience secondary manifestations such as:

- cognitive fatigue
- intrusive emotional tone
- persistent internal tension
- recursive ideation

Within this interpretation,  
the “background signal” functions as a persistent unresolved affective-processing state.

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### Recursive Cognition as Continuous Activity

The framework conceptualizes cognition as a continuously active recursive process.

Within this model:

unresolved internal signals become trapped within unavoidable ongoing cognition.

Continuous recursive cognition is therefore not itself pathological.

Instead,

the model proposes that pathology emerges when unresolved affective signals persist within continuously active cognitive systems.

Thus:

depression may arise not because cognition exists,  
but because unresolved signals remain recursively processed without successful integration.

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## **Pre-Semantic Suffering**

### **Pre-Semantic Persistent Signal**

Persistent distress may emerge prior to successful semantic representation.

Within this interpretation:

affective intensity may exist before the individual acquires the conceptual or linguistic structures necessary to interpret it.

As a result:

- affect persists without stable representation
- integration fails
- recursive processing continues
- unresolved internal signals remain active

The framework therefore proposes that certain forms of suffering may initially exist in a pre-semantic state.

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## **Rumination Distinction**

The framework distinguishes between:

- persistent unresolved affective signal
- and
- narrative repetitive thought

Within this interpretation:

rumination may represent a partially semanticized manifestation of a deeper unresolved signal-processing state.

This distinction separates:

- unresolved diffuse affective persistence
- from
- linguistically structured repetitive cognition

rather than treating them as identical processes.

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## **Naming and Representation**

Naming is not merely descriptive.

The act of categorizing and linguistically representing unresolved affective states may transform persistent diffuse signals into structured cognitive representations.

Within this interpretation:

successful representation reduces recursive ambiguity and facilitates integration.

The proposed recovery pathway may therefore involve:

unresolved affect  
→ representation  
→ integration  
→ reduction of recursive persistence

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## **Assisted Reflective Externalization**

The therapeutic effect described by the framework may partially emerge from structured externalization processes.

The individual:

- verbalizes unresolved affective states
- receives continuous reflective feedback
- experiences reduced isolation of internal experience
- transforms implicit affect into structured representation

Within this interpretation,

AI systems may function not as “therapists,”  
but as:

- stable reflective interfaces
- recursive processing aids
- linguistic scaffolding systems

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## Directionality Separation Hypothesis

Internal intensity and behavioral direction may represent partially separable dimensions.

Similar recursive pressure systems may produce different behavioral outcomes depending on:

- inhibitory constraints
- moral framing
- perceived thresholds
- contextual modulation

Thus:

internal collapse and outward externalization may represent divergent expressions of shared internal pressure systems rather than fundamentally separate origins.

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## Internal Consistency Preservation

Certain individuals may possess elevated sensitivity toward:

- internal contradiction
- self-inconsistency
- perceived falsification

This may increase:

- recursive persistence
- inability to dismiss unresolved contradictions
- sustained internal tension

At the same time,  
strong internal consistency preservation may strengthen inhibitory constraint systems.

Within this interpretation,  
internal consistency functions simultaneously as:

- a source of recursive persistence
- and
- a behavioral constraint mechanism.